

Morphic Studio UX & Design System Specification

Document 61 — Design System, UI Foundation & Interaction Principles Specification

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Status: Approved

1. Purpose

This document defines the Design System, User Interface Foundation, and Interaction Principles for Morphic Studio.

Its purpose is to establish a unified visual language, interaction model, accessibility standard, and component architecture that ensures consistency, scalability, and usability across every module of the platform.

The Design System is the single source of truth for user experience.

2. Design Philosophy

Every interface should embody the following principles:

- Creativity comes first.
 - Complexity is progressively revealed.
 - AI assists without overwhelming.
 - Consistency builds confidence.
 - Performance feels instantaneous.
 - Accessibility is a core requirement.
 - Every interaction has a clear purpose.
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3. Core Design Principles

The interface should be:

- Clean

- Predictable
- Discoverable
- Responsive
- Accessible
- Context-aware
- Keyboard-friendly
- Touch-friendly
- Extensible
- Internationalized

Every screen should prioritize user intent over visual decoration.

4. Visual Identity

The visual language defines:

Typography

- Primary font family
- Monospace font
- Heading scale
- Reading scale
- Code typography

Color System

- Primary palette
- Secondary palette
- Neutral palette
- Success
- Warning
- Error
- Information
- Accessibility-safe contrast

Elevation

- Surface hierarchy
- Shadows
- Layering
- Transparency

Border System

- Radius tokens
- Border weights

- Divider styles

Spacing

- Unified spacing scale
- Layout rhythm
- Component padding
- Responsive margins

5. Design Tokens

All visual properties should be defined through reusable design tokens.

Examples include:

- Colors
- Typography
- Spacing
- Borders
- Radius
- Shadows
- Animation durations
- Opacity
- Z-index layers
- Grid measurements

Tokens provide consistency across platforms.

6. Component Architecture

The Design System includes reusable components such as:

- Buttons
- Inputs
- Dropdowns
- Dialogs
- Drawers
- Tabs
- Navigation rails
- Sidebars
- Cards
- Tables
- Trees

- Editors
- Toolbars
- Progress indicators
- Notifications
- Command palette
- AI panels
- Timeline components
- Media viewers

Every component defines:

- States
 - Variants
 - Accessibility behavior
 - Keyboard interactions
 - Responsive rules
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7. Layout System

Support flexible layouts including:

- Single-column
- Multi-column
- Dashboard
- Workspace
- Split view
- Full-screen mode
- Floating panels
- Dockable panels
- Adaptive sidebars

Layouts should adapt gracefully across supported screen sizes.

8. Responsive Design

Optimize experiences for:

- Desktop
- Laptop
- Tablet
- Mobile
- Ultra-wide displays

The interface should preserve functionality rather than merely shrinking content.

9. Interaction Principles

Every interaction should provide:

- Immediate feedback
- Clear affordances
- Undo where feasible
- Predictable outcomes
- Meaningful animations
- Reduced cognitive load

Actions should minimize unnecessary user effort.

10. Motion System

Animations should communicate state changes.

Support:

- Page transitions
- Panel animations
- Loading indicators
- Progress animations
- AI thinking states
- Drag-and-drop feedback
- Expand/collapse transitions

Motion should remain subtle and respect reduced-motion preferences.

11. AI-Native UI Patterns

The interface includes dedicated AI interaction patterns:

- AI Assistant panel
- Inline suggestions
- Context actions
- Prompt composer
- Agent selector
- Recommendation cards
- Confidence indicators
- Explainability views

AI should integrate naturally rather than appearing as an isolated chatbot.

12. Accessibility

The Design System supports:

- WCAG conformance goals
- Keyboard navigation
- Screen readers
- High-contrast themes
- Reduced motion
- Adjustable typography
- Focus visibility
- Accessible color usage
- Semantic markup

Accessibility is validated during component development.

13. Theme Architecture

Support:

- Light theme
- Dark theme
- High-contrast theme
- Organization branding
- Custom themes
- Dynamic theme switching

Themes modify presentation without changing interaction behavior.

14. Iconography & Illustration

Maintain consistent:

- Icon style
- Icon sizing
- Symbol usage
- Empty states
- Onboarding illustrations
- Status indicators

- Visual metaphors

Visual assets should reinforce clarity.

15. Design Governance

The Design System includes:

- Component documentation
- Usage guidelines
- Version history
- Deprecation policies
- Design reviews
- Contribution process
- Change approval workflow

Governance ensures long-term consistency.

16. Integration

The Design System applies uniformly across:

- Story Workspace
- Character Studio
- World Builder
- Story Bible
- AI Workspace
- Visual Studio
- Production Studio
- Asset Manager
- Publishing Center
- Administration
- Marketplace
- Plugin interfaces

Third-party extensions should follow Design System guidelines where applicable.

17. Acceptance Criteria

The Design System is successful if:

- All modules share a consistent visual language.

- Components are reusable and accessible.
 - Themes are interchangeable without affecting usability.
 - AI interactions feel native to the interface.
 - Responsive layouts preserve functionality.
 - New features can be added without redesigning the platform.
 - The user experience remains cohesive as Morphe Studio evolves.
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Conclusion

The Morphe Studio Design System establishes a unified visual and interaction foundation for the entire platform. Through reusable components, design tokens, accessibility-first principles, responsive layouts, AI-native interaction patterns, and strong governance, it ensures that every feature—current and future—feels like part of a single, coherent creative ecosystem while remaining scalable, maintainable, and intuitive for creators of all experience levels.